weather, sleeping at night without a fur coat was unthinkable. Although the snow lay deep in most places in winter, the cold was not excessive in Kābul. In contrast, both Samarkand and Tabrīz, like Kābul, were noted for their pleasant climates, but they experienced extreme cold.

d. Meadows of Kābul

There were good meadows surrounding Kābul in all four directions. An excellent one, Sūng-qūrghān, was located approximately 4 miles (2 kuroh) to the northeast. It had lush grass suitable for horses and was relatively mosquito-free. To the northwest, there was the Chālāk meadow, about 2 miles (1 shar‘ī) away. Although it was spacious, it was plagued by mosquitoes that bothered the horses.

On the west, there were the Dūrrīn meadows, actually two of them: Tīpa and Qūsh-nādir (or nāwar), and if one counted both, there would be five meadows in total. Each of these meadows was about 2 miles away from the town. They were relatively small, had good grass for horses, and were free from mosquitoes. Kābul had no other meadows as favorable as these.

On the eastern side, there was the Siyāh-sang meadow, with Qūtlūq-qadam’s tomb situated between it and the Currier’s Gate. However, this meadow was not highly regarded because during the hot season, it was infested with mosquitoes. Adjacent to it was the Kamarī meadow. Including this one, the meadows around Kābul could be counted as six, but they were typically referred to as four.

e. Mountain-passes into Kābul

The country of Kābul was a formidable fortress, making it challenging for foreign invaders to penetrate. It was surrounded by the imposing Hindū-kush mountains, which acted as a natural barrier separating Kābul from Balkh, Qūndūz, and Badakhshān. These mountains had seven passable roads. Three of these roads extended from Panjhīr (Panj-sher): Khawāk, the highest; ṭūl, the next lower; and Bāzārak. The ṭūl road had the best pass, but it was the longest, hence its name. Bāzārak, while more direct, also led into Sar-i-āb, and the main pass through Pārandī was referred to as the Pārandī pass.

Another road led through Parwān, with seven minor passes known as Haft-bacha (Seven-younglings) between Parwān and its primary pass (Bāj-